Anxiety and Related Disorders

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Learn With PsycLearn Essentials

Module 2
Introduction to Psychological Disorders

Module 3
Opening to Anxiety Disorders

Module 4
Components of Anxiety

Components of Anxiety

- Pause and Reflect: An Angry Dog
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- **Diverse Manifestations of Anxiety Disorders**
  Reading • 3 min
- Manifestations of Intense Anxiety
  Video • 2 min
- Check Your Understanding: Components of Anxiety
  Practice Assignment • 4 min

Autonomic Nervous System

- Components of the Human Nervous System
  Video • 3 min
- Organs and Internal Systems Involved in Anxiety
  Video • 2 min
- Going Up the Sky Tower
  Video • 2 min
- The Components of the Autonomic Nervous System
  Reading • 1 min
- Check Your Understanding: Autonomic Nervous System
  Practice Assignment • 2 min
- Activity: Components of Anxiety
  Practice Assignment • 5 min

Key Takeaways

- Key Takeaways: Components of Anxiety
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4 Quiz

- Module Quiz: Components of Anxiety
  Graded Assignment • 10 min

Module 5
Disorders that Involve Anxiety Part 1

Module 6
Disorders that Involve Anxiety Part 2

Module 7
Conclusion

Module 8
Cumulative Quiz

Module 9
Course Resources

Module 10
PsycLearn Essentials APA Student Resources

Diverse Manifestations of Anxiety Disorders

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Everyone feels anxiety. Sometimes that anxiety feels pleasant, as when a friend is walking down the aisle to be married. At other times it can feel incredibly unpleasant, as when a police car turns on its lights behind our car. In each case, we can point to physiological signals that we're feeling anxious: Our heart rate increases, our pupils dilate, and we start to sweat. If the anxiety becomes too much to bear, we can use positive strategies to try to cope—such as deep breathing or mindfulness—or we can use less helpful strategies such as running away.

For most people, anxiety is helpful most of the time. It can get a person's body ready for an important game or stage performance. It can warn a person when danger is approaching. Or it can help ensure that a person is focusing on an important task. However, for people with anxiety disorders, the anxiety takes on a more negative quality. It can be inappropriately intense, out of proportion to the threat that's creating it, or inappropriately frequent, occurring without a good reason. It is often difficult or impossible to control with standard coping strategies, and it causes great distress or difficulty functioning in life. A person presenting with all of these symptoms is very likely to meet the criteria for an anxiety disorder.

How do people know when they are experiencing anxiety? To some, this might seem like an odd question, akin to asking how people know when they are awake. However, the symptoms of anxiety can be misinterpreted or attributed to something other than anxiety. In some cases, people have strategies to deal with the anxiety that have become so automatic, they engage them without experiencing the anxiety itself. Someone who describes themselves as an overthinker or a control freak—or who vegges out in front of a TV show for hour after hour—may very well be overthinking, seeking control, or distracting themselves from the world as a way of coping with their anxiety.

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